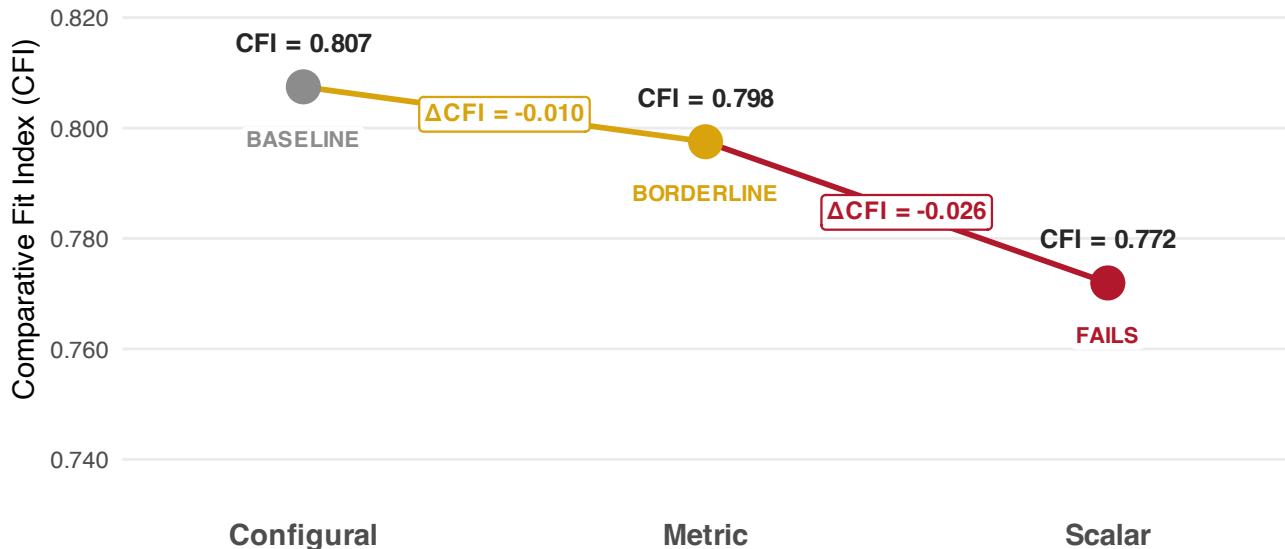


S4 multi-country invariance ladder

CFI drops as each invariance step adds constraints. Steeper drop = bigger constraint cost. $\Delta\text{CFI} \geq -0.005$ passes; ≥ -0.010 borderline; below that, fails.



Five-domain higher-order SEM, MLR estimator, country grouping (13 S4 countries). Slope between dots = ΔCFI vs prior step; verdicts use $\Delta\text{CFI} \geq -0.005$ = passes; ≥ -0.010 = borderline; else fails. N = 7,783.